LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

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PROFILE

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating batch and streaming data platforms for e-commerce, payments and logistics. Experienced in Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, cloud data warehouses and large-scale data processing. Focused on reliable pipelines, clear data contracts, data quality and trusted data models for analysts and business teams.

CORE SKILLS

Data platforms: Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL

Programming: Python, SQL, Bash

Data processing and quality: PySpark, Great Expectations, JSON Schema, CI checks

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions

Data modelling and BI: Dimensional modelling, Power BI, Looker (basic)

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka | 03/2022 - present

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform, operating approximately 140 Airflow DAGs that load data from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt, delivering 420+ models with tests on every model and reducing nightly run time from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes.
- Introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks between product teams and the data team, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately 9 per month to 2 per month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming to process approximately 30 million shipment-tracking events per day.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers and lead weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb | 09/2019 - 02/2022

- Built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR for transaction reconciliation, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files from S3 daily.
- Designed a Redshift warehouse using a star schema with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams.
- Implemented Great Expectations data quality checks for critical finance tables.
- Developed an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Catalog access, adopted by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split | 06/2017 - 08/2019

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL workflows feeding an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations across more than 40 stores.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University | 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)